

Ἀπολλώνιος ὁ Δύσκολος

Apollonius the Grammarian and the Homeric Lexicon

eul_aid: pjg

Period: Ῥωμαϊκή [Roman](#)
Dialect: Κοινή τεχνική [Technical Koine](#)
Domain: Γραμματική [Grammar](#)
Format: Πραγματεία [Treatise](#)

Apollonius Dyscolus was a Greek scholar who lived and worked in Alexandria, Egypt, during the 2nd century CE, a period when the region was part of the Roman Empire. He was a grammarian, specializing in the systematic study of language. His nickname "Dyscolus," meaning "the Surly" or "the Difficult," likely referred to his challenging personality or the complex nature of his work. He belonged to a family of scholars; his father was also a grammarian, and his son, Aelius Herodianus, became a prominent grammarian as well. According to later accounts, Apollonius was blind in his later life.

Apollonius wrote many technical treatises on different parts of Greek grammar. His most important and complete surviving work is *On Syntax*, which comprises four books. Other surviving treatises include *On Pronouns*, *On Conjunctions*, and *On Adverbs*. Many of his other works are lost or survive only in fragments.

Modern scholars consider Apollonius Dyscolus a foundational figure in the history of linguistics. His major work, *On Syntax*, represents the first known systematic and theoretical analysis of how sentences are structured in any language. He established a framework for understanding the relationships between words and the functions of different parts of speech. His rational, principle-based approach influenced later Greek, Roman, and Byzantine grammarians. His theories were a major source for the influential Latin grammarian Priscian in the 6th century CE, thereby helping to shape the study of grammar in medieval Europe.

Works (1)

- [Λεξικὸν Ὅμηρικόν](#) · [Homeric Lexicon](#) · 171 passages